Vowels & Consonants

- Difference between Consonant and Vowel.
- Consonants

Difference between Consonant and Vowel.

- Speech sounds are very divided into broadly into **two categories**,
- namely **vowels and consonants**.
- If we say English words- **shoe or shine**, we realizes that the words are made up of two sounds, one represented by the letter ' **Sh**' and the letters **'oe'**
- When we produce the sounds represented by the letters 'sh' slowly, we see that during the production of this sound, the air escapes through the mouth with friction.
- when we produce the sound represented by the letters 'oe', the air escapes through the mouth freely and we do not hear any friction.
- The sound that is represented by letters **'sh**' in the word shoe is a **consonant** and sound represented by '**oe'** in the word shoe is a **vowel**.
- If we say words **she, shoe, shy, show and ship**, we produce the sounds represented by letters- **e, oe, y,ow & i** in these words , the air escapes through the mouth freely without friction

Difference between Consonants and Vowels cont….

- Similarly in words- shoe , zoo, and who, we hear a friction during the production of the sounds represented by the letters sh, s, z and wh.
- All these sounds are therefore consonants.
- The Vowels and consonants are further classified into other sub categories.

Consonants

Most consonants are divided into **voiced** or **unvoiced** depending on the vibration of vocal cords.

Voiced

/b/ as in ***b**each, we**b**, su**b**way...*

/d/ as in ***D**ani, sa**d**, a**dd**...*

/g/ as in ***g**irl, dra**g**, clo**gg**ed...*

/dʒ/ as in ***j**am, **g**el, **g**in, **j**oy, ed**g**e...*

/v/ as in ***v**ehicle, li**v**e...*

/ð / as in ***th**is, fa**th**er...*

/z/ as in ***z**oo, ro**s**e...*

/ʒ/ as in *vi**s**ion, plea**s**ure, bei**g**e...*

Consonants

Unvoiced

/p/ as in ***p**otato, ta**p**, cla**pp**ing...*

/t/ as in ***t**ea, pe**t**, se**tt**ing ...*

/k/ as in ***c**ar, **k**ey, tre**kk**ing, chi**ck**en, a**cc**urate, **qu**een, thi**ck**, boo**k**, **ch**aos...*

/f/ as in ***f**ast, **ph**one, lea**f**, sta**ff**, enou**gh**...*

/s/ as in **s**ell, **c**ity, **p**ass...

/θ/ as in ***th**in, tee**th**...*

/ʃ/ as in ***sh**e, **s**ugar, na**ti**on, lea**sh**...*

/tʃ/ as in *charity, na**t**ure, tea**ch**...*

Consonants

Finally there are other consonants to consider:

/m/ as in ***m****an, To****m****, tri****mm****ed...*

/n/ as in ***n****ose, si****n****, ru****nn****ing...*

/ŋ/ as in *ri****n****ger, si****ng****, si****nk****...*

/l/ as in ***l****ate, ta****l****e, ta****ll****, ca****ll****ed...*

/h/ as in ***h****it, a****h****ead...*

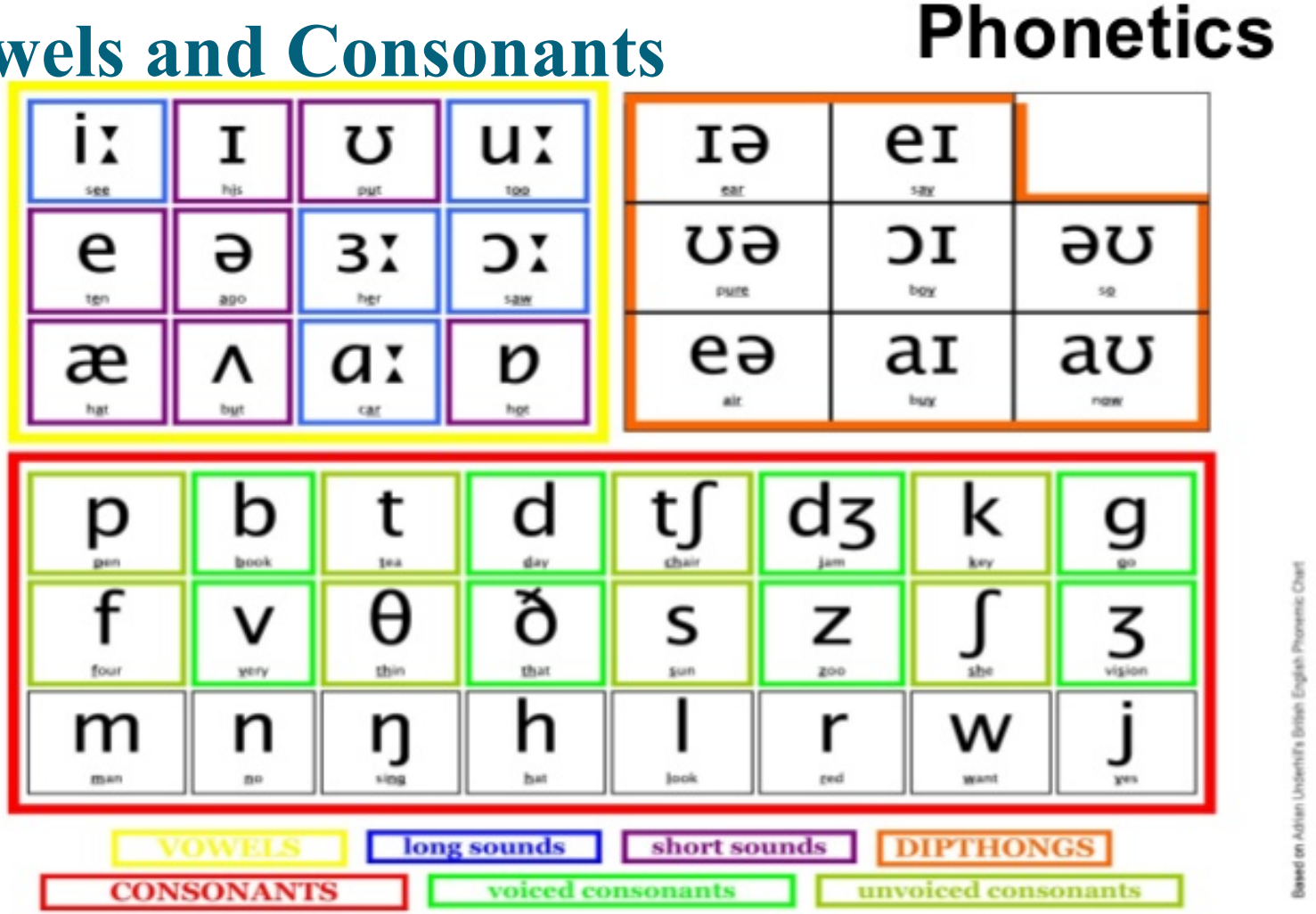
/r/ as in ***r****at, ve****r****y, ca****rr****ot...*

Semivowels or semiconsonants

They are sounds that share some characteristics with vowels and others with consonants. There are **2** semivowels in English.
Here are they:

/w/ as in *t**w**elve, conq**u**est, lang**u**age...*
/j/ as in ***y**es, **u**niform, **Eu**rope...*

Vowels and Consonants



Questions?

- Q1. Explain the difference between Consonant and vowel.
- Transcribe the following words as per the IPA symbols:
- i)sip -/sip/ vii)zink- /zink/
- ii)Sheep **/ʃi:p/** viii) tax
- iii)Pen /pen/ ix) boil
- iv)Chips x) educate
- v)Them xi) computer
- vi)game xii) future

Identify the words?

- /mæn/- man
- /fæmili/- family
- / b3:**θ**dei /- birthday
- /**θ**ɪŋz/-things
- /ænd/-and
- /sku:l/- school
- /m**aʊθ/-mouth**
- **/feə/- fear**

/pa:**θ/- path**

/w**ɒʃ/- wash**